

Malta among the EU's highest fossil-fuel subsidies relative to GDP?

An EEA ranking, rebuilt from the Commission's subsidy database

THE CLAIM

“... the highest shares of [GDP] in Malta, Poland, and Slovakia (all at or above 1.5%).”

European Environment Agency, Fossil fuel subsidies in Europe, published 29 Jan 2025

The sentence begins “In 2023, fossil fuel subsidies represented”; [GDP] abridges “gross domestic product (GDP)”.

Same wording in every copy we read (3 Feb 2025 to 6 Oct 2026). Subsidies counted the EU way, from Commission data.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*The ranking is right;
the 1.5% line is close.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

3.37%

Reproduced exactly

Malta's 2023 share of GDP on the EEA's data. Poland 2.09%, Slovakia 1.51%; EU-27 as a whole 0.66%.

Top 3

A robust ranking

The same three lead with Eurostat's GDP and, as a lower bound, without the unconfirmed items.

1.49%

Slovakia at the line

With Eurostat's GDP of Oct 2026 (later than the EEA's), Slovakia falls just under 1.5%.

96%

One measure

Of Malta's 2023 figure: compensation to Enemalta for keeping energy prices frozen.

2.1×

Size uncertain

The 2023 amount is 2.1 times the IMF Article IV estimate of Malta's energy-subsidy cost; for 2022 it was lower.

FAIR TO SAY

Before 2021 Malta was among the EU's lowest (about 0.1% of GDP). In euros it is 19th of 27. The IMF's price-gap data record no explicit subsidy for Malta. The Commission's 2026 report puts Malta first again, for 2024.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The source and basis of Malta's EUR 580m.

☐ Final 2023 figures for every country.

☐ Malta's yearly outturn cost of energy support.

☐ The GDP series behind the EEA's chart.